

Court No. - 32

Case :- WRIT - C No. - 38968 of 2019

Petitioner :- Subhash

Respondent :- Paschimanchal Vidyut Vitran
Nigam Limited And 04 Others

Counsel for Petitioner :- Ashok Kumar

Counsel for Respondent :- C.S.C., Pranjali
Mehrotra

Hon'ble Shashi Kant Gupta,J.

Hon'ble Piyush Agrawal,J.

This writ petition has been filed, inter alia, for the following reliefs:

"(I) Issue a writ of certiorari for quashing the impugned recovery citation dated 20.08.2019 passed/issued by respondent no. 5 Tehsildar, Tehsil & District Moradabad for recovery of amount of Rs.11,39,107/- towards electricity bill from the petitioner.

(II) Issue a writ, order or direction in the nature of mandamus to the respondents not to initiate any coercive step against the petitioner for payment of amount of recovery amount till it finalize and re-assess after enquiry by the respondent authorities.

Heard the learned counsel for the petitioner, learned counsel for the electricity department and perused the record.

Learned counsel for the petitioner has submitted that the respondents are taking coercive action against the petitioner without giving any opportunity of hearing and without following the provisions contained under the U.P. Electricity Supply Code 2005.

Considering the facts and circumstances of the case and taking a lenient view in the matter, we direct the petitioner to appear on 12.12.2019 at 11.00 A.M. before the Respondent No.2, Executive Engineer along with his objection and adduce his evidence, if any, in support of his contention. The Respondent No.2, thereafter, shall pass a final order by a speaking and reasoned order after considering the objections of the petitioner as well as the contention raised by the petitioner within a period of four weeks thereafter.

For a period of seven weeks from today or till the disposal of the representation/objection, whichever is earlier, no coercive action shall be taken against the petitioner. In case of default in filing the objection/representation, as indicated herein above, the present interim order shall stand vacated automatically.

In case the petitioner is aggrieved with the final order, if any, passed against the petitioner, it will be open for the petitioner to file an appeal before the concerned authority under Section 127 of the Electricity Act, 2003 in accordance with law.

It is made clear that in case the petitioner does not appear on the said date fixed, the impugned recovery citation shall stand revived automatically.

With the above observations, the writ petition stands disposed of.

Order Date :- 28.11.2019

Arun